

Chapter 6 — Report Card Comments

30 prompts

Twenty-eight comments in one sitting is the job nobody plans for and everybody dreads. These prompts do the drafting so you can do the judging — every comment tied to something you actually recorded, with one next step the student can act on.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Comment banks	10	Build once, reuse every term
Strengths and next steps	7	The core shape of a good comment
Subject-specific comments	7	Language that fits the subject
Bulk drafts from evidence	4	A whole class in one pass
Tone and rewriting	3	Honest, but survivable to read

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Use initials or "Student A". These comments go into a permanent record. The drafting should not put a child's name into an AI tool.

Give it your real evidence — scores, dates, things you wrote down. A comment built on nothing reads like a comment built on nothing.

Do not let it invent a strength to balance the structure. A manufactured compliment is the fastest way for a family to stop trusting the rest.

Vary the openings. Twenty-eight comments that all begin the same way are recognisable as generated, and parents compare.

COMMENT BANKS

RC-001 Build an evidence-safe comment bank

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Build it once in January and use it every term after.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a report comment bank for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me 6 comments for each of these bands: excelling, secure, approaching, and inconsistent evidence.

Every comment must contain:

- [NAME] once, at the start
- [SPECIFIC EVIDENCE] – a blank I fill with something real from my records
- One next step the student can act on themselves

Rules:

- No comment may be sendable without filling the evidence blank. Write them so the gap is obvious
- Describe what the student did, never what kind of learner they are
- No praise for effort, attitude, behaviour or personality unless I add it
- Vary the openings across the bank – list them so I can check no two match
- Nothing that predicts or promises future performance

Then tell me which band is hardest to write honestly, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could any comment be sent without filling the evidence blank? Tighten it.
- Do the openings genuinely differ?

RC-004 Create comment starters for four levels of demonstrated mastery

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Openings that describe the learning rather than rank the child.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write comment openings for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] at four levels of demonstrated mastery.

Give me 5 openings per level. Each must:

- Describe what the student has demonstrated, in the work
- Be followed naturally by a specific piece of evidence
- Avoid comparison with other students or with a class average
- Avoid any word implying fixed ability – bright, weak, able, gifted, slow, natural, struggles

For the lowest band especially: the opening must be honest without being a verdict on the child. Show me the difference between an honest opening and a discouraging one, with an example of each.

Then tell me which openings would sound wrong if a family read four of them in a row from different teachers.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would you be comfortable if a family compared four of these?
- Any fixed-ability words left?

RC-005 Build modular strength, evidence and next-step sentence parts

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Mix and match, so thirty comments do not read as one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build modular comment parts for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that I can combine.

Give me three separate lists:

- 8 strength openings
- 8 evidence connectors, each leading into a [SPECIFIC EXAMPLE] blank
- 8 next-step closings

Every combination must produce a grammatical, natural comment. Show me four assembled examples using different combinations.

Rules:

- No part may contain a fact – the facts come from my blanks
- Next steps must be things the student can do, not things that will happen to them
- No closing may promise a result

Then tell me which combinations sound wrong together, so I avoid them at 10pm.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Assemble three at random. Do they read naturally?
- Do any parts carry a claim you have not verified?

RC-006 Create a comment bank that avoids fixed-ability labels

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Language that describes this term, not the child's ceiling.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a comment bank for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that describes learning as it stands now, not as a fixed trait.

Banned outright: bright, able, gifted, weak, low, high, slow, natural, struggles with, is not a [subject] person, lacks ability, and any comparison to peers.

Give me:

- 12 comments describing current demonstrated learning
- For each, the fixed-ability phrasing it replaces, so I can see the swap
- The three phrases teachers reach for most that sound neutral but are not
- How to describe a student who is genuinely far behind, honestly, without making it sound permanent

That last one is the point of this prompt. Do not avoid it by being vague.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the far-behind comment honest, or has it gone vague to be kind?
- Check your own habitual phrases against the list of three.

RC-007 Write concise comments within a strict character limit

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The reporting system allows 250 characters and no argument.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comments within [NUMBER] characters including spaces.

Evidence: [PASTE WHAT YOU HAVE – no names]

Rules:

- Count the characters and state the count after each comment
- Cut adverbs and hedging before cutting substance
- The next step survives the cut. If something has to go, it is not that
- No abbreviations a family would have to decode
- Still specific – a short comment is not an excuse for a generic one

Give me each comment with its character count, and tell me what you dropped to fit.

If the evidence genuinely cannot be said in [NUMBER] characters without becoming meaningless, say so rather than producing something empty.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify the character counts yourself. They are often wrong.
- Did the next step survive?

RC-008 Create neutral pronoun variants without changing the evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One comment, correct for any student, no rewriting at 11pm.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments so pronouns are not baked in.

Give me each comment in two forms:

- Using the student's name where a pronoun would go, so it works for anyone
- With a [PRONOUN] placeholder and a note on which forms are needed – subject, object, possessive

Rules:

- The evidence and the next step must be identical across versions
- Do not add or remove meaning in the rewrite
- Keep the sentences natural – repeated names every clause reads oddly, so restructure rather than substitute mechanically

Flag any sentence that cannot be made pronoun-neutral without becoming awkward,
and give me your best alternative.

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read one aloud. Does the name repeat too often?
- Is the evidence identical across versions?

RC-009 Build a comment bank with visible placeholders for supporting evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So the blank cannot be skipped when you are tired.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment bank where the evidence blanks are impossible to miss.

For each comment:

- Put placeholders in a form that stands out visibly, such as [[LIKE THIS]]
- Every comment needs at least one evidence placeholder and one next-step placeholder
- Write a one-line rule beside each placeholder saying what belongs there – the kind of evidence, not an example I might just copy

Give me 10 comments across the range.

Then give me the two-line check I run before submitting: what to search for to confirm no placeholder survived into a final comment.

Do not fill any placeholder with a plausible example. That is exactly how an invented detail ends up in a permanent record.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Search the final file for `[[`. Every one must be gone.
- Has any placeholder been helpfully pre-filled?

RC-010 Audit a comment bank for repetition, vagueness and invented claims

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it goes into use for three years.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment bank.

Tell me:

- Which comments are the same comment in different words
- Which contain no actual information – quote the empty phrases
- Which make a claim that cannot be evidenced from classroom work
- Which describe personality, effort or attitude rather than learning
- Which imply a fixed ability
- Which would sound identical if a family compared two children's reports
- Which promise or predict a future outcome

Then tell me:

- The comments to delete entirely
- The single vaguest phrase in the whole bank

BANK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Delete what it said to delete. A bank of 30 good comments beats 60 mixed.
- Is the vaguest phrase one you use often?

STRENGTHS AND NEXT STEPS

RC-002 Turn evidence into a balanced report comment

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The core shape: what they can do, what comes next, both evidenced.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a report comment for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Evidence I have: [LIST IT – scores, observations, dates, work. No names.]

Structure:

- A strength, with the evidence stated
- A next step, specific and achievable this term
- Nothing else

Rules:

- Every factual clause must trace to something I gave you. Mark any clause you cannot trace, rather than including it
- Do not manufacture a strength to balance the comment. If my evidence shows no clear strength, say so and tell me what to look for
- The next step is something the student does, not something I do
- No prediction, no promise, no praise for effort I did not describe
- [NUMBER] sentences

Give me the comment, plus a note on which clause rests on the thinnest evidence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Trace every clause to your own records.
- If it said the evidence shows no strength, do not add one.

RC-011 Write a strength statement tied to a specific learning objective

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"Doing well" means nothing. This says in what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a strength statement for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Objective: [PASTE IT]

What the student did: [THE EVIDENCE – no names]

The statement must name the objective in family-readable language and point at what the student actually produced.

Give me:

- The strength statement, one or two sentences
- The same statement without the jargon, if my objective contains any
- What makes this a strength rather than simply completing the task
- A version for a student whose strength is real but narrow – secure in one part of the objective and not the rest

Do not broaden the claim beyond my evidence. One good piece of work is not a consistent pattern, and should not be described as one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has one instance been described as a pattern?
- Would a family understand the objective as written?

RC-012 Convert an error pattern into one achievable next step

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One next step. Not four, and not a wish.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] error pattern into a single next step:

[DESCRIBE WHAT KEEPS HAPPENING IN THE WORK – no names]

The next step must be:

- One thing, not a list
- Something the student can start without me
- Achievable this term, not aspirational
- Written so the student understands what to do differently

Give me:

- The next step, one sentence
- The same thing said to the student directly
- What I do in class to support it
- How I would know in three weeks whether it worked

Do not write "should continue to practise" or "needs to focus more". Those are not next steps. If the pattern needs teaching rather than practice, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the student start this tomorrow, alone?
- Is it one thing?

RC-013 Build a balanced comment from assessment and classroom evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The test score and what you see daily do not agree.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a report comment combining assessment and classroom evidence for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Assessment evidence: [SCORES, DATES]

Classroom evidence: [WHAT YOU OBSERVE – no names]

Where these disagree, say so rather than averaging them into a bland middle.

Give me:

- The comment
- Which evidence you weighted more, and why
- The sentence handling the disagreement honestly, without explaining it away
- What I should say if a family asks why the comment and the grade differ

If the two sources disagree strongly enough that I should gather more evidence before reporting, tell me that instead of writing the comment.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with which evidence it weighted?
- Can you answer the family question it prepared you for?

RC-014 Write a comment when evidence is limited or inconsistent

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Long absence, arrived late in the term, or the evidence simply is not there.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment where I have limited evidence.

What I have: [LIST IT HONESTLY, INCLUDING GAPS AND WHY – no names]

Rules:

- Say plainly what the comment is based on, and over what period
- Do not extrapolate from a small sample into a general judgement
- Do not fill the gap with attendance commentary, effort, or behaviour
- Do not imply the student is behind if I do not have evidence for that
- Give a next step only if the evidence supports one; otherwise say what I will look for next term

Give me the comment and one line I could add explaining the limited basis without sounding defensive.

Tell me if the honest answer is that I cannot write a meaningful comment yet.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has thin evidence quietly become a judgement?
- Is the limitation stated plainly?

RC-015 Create a learner-friendly next step that families can understand

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The next step should mean something to the child it is about.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this next step so a [GRADE] student and their family both understand it:

[PASTE IT]

Give me:

- The next step in student-facing words
- The same for a family, with no subject jargon
- One concrete example of what doing it looks like
- One thing a family could do to help, taking under ten minutes and requiring no subject knowledge

Rules:

- Do not ask a family to teach anything
- Do not assume internet, a printer, purchased resources, or an adult free at a fixed time
- Keep the demand identical to the original – plainer words, same expectation

Flag anything in the original the student could not act on alone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the family suggestion require any teaching? Cut it if so.
- Is the demand unchanged?

RC-016 Add an instructional strategy without promising a future result

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Saying what you will do, without guaranteeing what will happen.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Add to this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment a line about what I will do in class:

[PASTE THE COMMENT]

What I plan to do: [DESCRIBE IT]

Rules:

- State the action, not the expected outcome
- No promise, no prediction, no "this will help them to"
- No timescale I cannot guarantee
- It must be something I will actually do, not a general intention
- One sentence

Give me three versions at different levels of specificity, and tell me which is safest to put in a permanent record.

Then flag any sentence in my original comment that already promises a result.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Will you actually do it? It is now on a record.
- Any promises left in the original?

RC-017 Audit a report comment using a sentence-by-sentence fact trace

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The last check before it becomes permanent.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Trace this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment against my evidence.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

EVIDENCE: [PASTE WHAT YOU HAVE]

For each sentence, tell me:

- Which piece of evidence supports it
- Whether it is fully supported, partly supported, or unsupported
- Where it generalises beyond what the evidence shows
- Whether it describes learning, or effort, behaviour or personality
- Whether a family could challenge it and be right

Then give me:

- The sentence to cut
- The sentence to soften
- Anything the evidence supports that the comment does not mention

Do not accept a sentence as supported because it sounds reasonable.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Cut what it said to cut.
- Anything unsupported goes, however true it feels.

SUBJECT-SPECIFIC COMMENTS

RC-018 Write a mathematics comment about concepts, procedures and reasoning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"Good at maths" hides which of the three is actually strong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] mathematics report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK SHOWS – no names]

Separate three things, because a student can be strong in one and not the others:

- Conceptual understanding – do they know what it means
- Procedural fluency – can they carry it out reliably
- Reasoning and explanation – can they justify and communicate it

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of the three is the strength and which is the next step
- The sentence a family will understand, since these three sound alike to non-teachers
- What a student who is procedurally fluent but conceptually shaky looks like, so I can check I have read my evidence correctly

If my evidence only covers one of the three, say so rather than commenting on all three.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does your evidence actually cover what the comment claims?
- Would a family understand the distinction as written?

RC-019 Write a science comment about investigation, evidence and explanation

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Practical work and written explanation are different skills.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] science report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK AND PRACTICALS SHOW – no names]

Distinguish:

- Working scientifically – planning, controlling variables, measuring, recording
- Handling evidence – reading data, spotting patterns, noting limitations
- Explaining – using scientific ideas to account for what was observed

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of these the evidence supports
- The distinction between a student who follows a method well and one who understands why the method is designed that way
- A next step for a student strong in practical work and weak in written explanation, that is not simply "write more"

Do not credit understanding from a neat write-up alone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you crediting understanding, or presentation?
- Is the next step more than "write more"?

RC-020 Write an English language arts comment about reading and writing evidence

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reading and writing are separate, and so is talking about them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] English report comment.

Evidence: [READING AND WRITING EVIDENCE – no names]

Keep reading and writing separate. A student can comprehend well and write poorly, and the comment should not blur them.

For reading, distinguish: decoding, literal comprehension, inference, and response to a text.

For writing, distinguish: ideas, structure, sentence control, and technical accuracy.

Give me:

- The comment, naming specifically where the strength and next step sit
- Why technical accuracy should not dominate the comment if the ideas are strong
- A next step for a student whose ideas outrun their sentence control

Do not describe a student as a "reluctant" or "confident" reader or writer. Those are dispositions, not evidence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has technical accuracy swamped everything else?
- Any disposition language left?

RC-021 Write a social studies comment about sources, claims and perspective

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Content recall and historical thinking are not the same achievement.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] social studies report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK SHOWS – no names]

Distinguish:

- Knowledge of content
- Using sources – reading them, questioning them, weighing them
- Constructing an argument with evidence
- Recognising perspective and that accounts differ

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of these the evidence supports
- The difference between a student who recounts and one who argues
- A next step for a student with strong recall and weak source handling

Where the subject matter is contested or sensitive, keep the comment about the student's reasoning, not about the positions they took.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it commenting on reasoning, or on views?
- Does your evidence cover source work at all?

RC-022 Write an arts comment about process, technique and reflection

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The finished piece is not the whole of the learning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] [ART FORM] report comment.

Evidence: [PROCESS, TECHNIQUE, FINISHED WORK, REFLECTION – no names]

Distinguish:

- Process – development, iteration, responding to feedback
- Technique – the specific skills demonstrated
- Reflection – can they talk about choices and why they made them

Give me:

- The comment, naming which the evidence supports
- Language for a student whose technique is developing but whose process is strong, that does not read as consolation
- A next step tied to a specific technique or process, not to "creativity"

Do not comment on talent, flair, or natural ability. Comment on what was done and what was learned.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the developing-technique version read as consolation?
- Any talent language left?

RC-023 Write a physical education comment using observable skill evidence

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Comment on the learning, not on the body.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] physical education report comment.

Evidence: [OBSERVED SKILLS, DECISION-MAKING, PARTICIPATION IN LEARNING – no names]

Rules – these matter more than the wording:

- Comment on skill, technique, tactical decisions and application of learning
- Say nothing about a student's body, size, shape, weight, speed relative to peers, or fitness as a personal quality
- Say nothing about natural athleticism or talent
- Do not use participation as a proxy for learning
- A student with limited mobility or a medical restriction must be reportable on the same terms, on what they demonstrated

Give me the comment, and a version for a student whose physical performance is limited but whose understanding and decision-making are strong.

Flag any phrase in this that could read as a comment on the child rather than the learning.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read it as the child. Is any of it about their body?
- Would it work for a student with a restriction?

RC-024 Audit subject-specific terminology for accuracy and family clarity

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The words are correct and the family has no idea what they mean.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit the subject terminology in these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments.

For each term:

- Is it used accurately
- Would a family outside education understand it
- Does it mean something different in everyday English – flag those especially
- Could it be replaced without losing precision, and what is the replacement

Then tell me:

- Which terms to keep and gloss in place, because precision matters
- Which to replace outright
- Any term used inconsistently across the set
- Anything that sounds more serious to a family than I intend, or less

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- The "sounds more serious than intended" flag matters most. Act on it.
- Is your terminology consistent across the whole set?

BULK DRAFTS FROM EVIDENCE

RC-025 Create distinct comment drafts from a fictional evidence table

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Testing your evidence format before you use it on a real class.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a worked example of bulk comment drafting for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Invent a fictional evidence table for 6 students – label them Student A to F and state clearly that they are fabricated. Include a range: strong, secure, approaching, inconsistent, limited evidence, and one where the assessment and classroom evidence disagree.

Then draft a comment for each.

Give me:

- The fictional table
- The 6 comments
- For each, which column of the table produced which clause
- The evidence format that made drafting easiest, so I know what to record during term

This is a template test, not real reporting. Do not present the fictional students as real.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the recommended evidence format match what you can realistically collect?
- Are the six genuinely different in shape?

RC-026 Generate bulk comments without mixing one learner's evidence with another

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty comments in one pass, and nothing may cross between them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Draft report comments from this evidence table for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

[PASTE YOUR TABLE – use initials or Student A, B, C. No full names.]

Rules – the first is the one that matters:

- Every clause in a comment must come from that student's own row. Never carry a detail, a phrase or an achievement from one row into another
- If a row is thin, write a shorter comment. Do not borrow to fill it
- Vary structure and openings across the set
- Mark any clause you could not source to the row

Give me the comments, and afterwards a checklist: for each student, the row facts used and any facts unused.

Then flag any two comments similar enough that a family comparing them would notice.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check the used-facts list against your table, row by row.
- This is where evidence leaks between students. Do not skip this check.

RC-027 Vary sentence structure while preserving every supplied fact

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty accurate comments that do not read as one comment thirty times.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments so they vary in structure, without changing a single fact.

Give me:

- Each comment rewritten
- A note confirming every fact from the original is present in the rewrite
- Anything I should check because the rewording shifted the emphasis
- The list of opening words used across the whole set, so I can see none repeats

Rules:

- No fact added, removed, softened or strengthened
- Vary sentence length as well as opening – thirty comments of identical rhythm
read as generated even when the words differ
- Keep every next step exactly as demanding as it was

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Spot-check three rewrites against the originals for changed emphasis.
- Do the openings genuinely differ?

RC-028 Audit a bulk comment set for duplicates, contradictions and evidence leakage

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The final pass before thirty comments go on thirty permanent records.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this set of [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comments against the evidence table.

Check for:

- Any detail appearing in a comment that belongs to a different student's row
- Comments similar enough that a family comparing two would notice
- Any comment contradicting its own evidence row
- Any claim not sourced to the table at all
- Any placeholder left unfilled
- Any comment about effort, behaviour or personality rather than learning
- Repeated opening words or repeated closing sentences

Report leakage first and separately. That is the error that does real damage.

EVIDENCE TABLE: [PASTE IT]

COMMENTS: [PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every leakage claim against your table yourself.
- Search for unfilled placeholders one more time.

tone and rewriting

RC-003 Rewrite a comment for clarity and fairness

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know what you mean. This makes it survivable for a family to read.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment so it is honest but not deflating.

Keep every fact. Do not soften it into meaninglessness – a family must still understand there is a concern and what happens next.

Give me three versions: gentle, direct, and firm.

For each, tell me:

- What changed from my original
- What a family would take away
- What the student would take away, if they read it

Then tell me which version fits what I described, and flag anything in my original that is a judgement rather than an observation.

COMMENT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are all the facts still present in the version you pick?
- Read it as the student. Would you keep going after reading it?

RC-029 Replace harsh or vague judgments with verified learning evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The comment says something about the child that the evidence does not.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment, replacing judgement with evidence.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

EVIDENCE: [PASTE WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HAVE]

For each judgement in the original:

- Quote it
- Say what it claims about the student
- Say whether my evidence supports it
- Replace it with what the evidence actually shows

Pay particular attention to: lazy, careless, unmotivated, does not try, capable but, could do better, disruptive, immature, and anything about attitude.

If a judgement is unsupported, do not soften it – remove it. A gently worded unsupported claim is still an unsupported claim on a permanent record.

Then tell me what the comment says once every unsupported claim is gone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If little is left, that is the finding. Gather evidence rather than rewording.
- Any attitude language surviving?

RC-030 Shorten a report comment without removing the material concern

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Over the limit, and the concern is the part that must not go.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Shorten this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment to [NUMBER] characters or [NUMBER] words.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

Rules for what goes first:

1. Hedging, adverbs and repetition
2. The second example, if there are two
3. Restatement of the strength

What must survive, in order:

1. The concern, stated plainly
2. The next step
3. One piece of evidence

Give me the shortened version, the count, and a list of what you removed.

Then tell me whether the shortened version still conveys the concern with the same weight. If it does not, say so – going over the limit and asking for an exception is better than a comment that no longer says what I meant.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the shorter version still land the concern?
- Verify the count yourself.